SUPPLEMENT · SESSION 2

The Six Satisfaction Elements and PERFECT Care

This supplement adds two classic tools to Chapter 2. Use them with the Kano Model: the six elements tell you **where** customers judge you; Kano tells you **how much** each feature matters.

Key idea: customer service is an attitude, not a department. Every part of the organisation affects what customers decide.

Six elements of customer satisfaction

When customers choose a business, often in a few seconds and without thinking about it, they judge six elements. Together, these make up the whole offer.

1 · Product or service	**2 · Sales**	**3 · After-sales**
4 · Location	**5 · Time**	**6 · Culture**

Based on Wellington, P. (2010) Effective Customer Care, Chapter 1. Summarised in our own words.

Why managers use this list

See the whole offer
Customers compare much more than the product and the price.

Find weak spots
One weak element can lose a customer, even if the rest is excellent.

Set standards
Each element can be turned into clear standards for the team.

1 Product or service

The customer asks: Is it what I need? Is it good quality? Is it worth the price? Can I get it now?

Excellence looks like: It is available when promised, it works every time, the image matches reality, and the customer feels they got more value than they paid for.

Doha example: A phone shop has the model in stock today and it works perfectly out of the box.

2 Sales

The customer asks: How are the brochures, the website and the store? How do the staff speak to me? Is it easy to pay?

Excellence looks like: Honest, helpful marketing; staff who listen and respond quickly; a clean, comfortable place to buy; simple paperwork and payment.

Doha example: A clear website that loads fast on a phone, and staff who greet the customer within seconds.

3 After-sales

The customer asks: Will they look after me after I pay? If something goes wrong, will they fix it?

Excellence looks like: Loyal customers are recognised and rewarded; complaints are handled quickly, politely and honestly by staff who are allowed to solve them.

Doha example: The service centre sees the customer's purchase history and replaces a faulty item on the spot.

4 Location

The customer asks: Is it easy to find and reach? Is it safe and comfortable? Can everyone use it?

Excellence looks like: Clear directions and signs, easy parking and access, a safe and comfortable space, and nothing that excludes customers with special needs.

Doha example: A mall clinic with clear signs from the car park, a lift and wheelchair access.

5 Time

The customer asks: Are they open when I need them? How long will it take?

Excellence looks like: Opening hours that suit customers, not the competition; products that fit the season; transactions as short as customers want.

Doha example: Longer opening hours during Ramadan evenings, and online booking at any time.

6 Culture

The customer asks: Are they honest and fair? Do the staff seem to care?

Excellence looks like: Ethical, fair and honest behaviour; staff who are trusted, trained and supported; colleagues treated as internal customers.

Doha example: Staff are trained and allowed to decide small refunds without asking a manager.

THE MOMENT OF SERVICE TRUTH

First contact decides a lot

The first contact can be a visit, a call, an email or a message. At that moment, the customer cannot judge the product yet. **They can only judge the behaviour of the person in front of them**: their attitude, interest and willingness to help.

What "care" really means

Not caring
Following the rules only: serving fast, answering the right number of calls, without treating the customer as a person.

Caring
Going out of your way: a real smile, reading the customer's mood, and giving them what they need at that moment.

The PERFECT mnemonic

P	E	R	F	E	C	T
Professional	Efficient	Reliable	Friendly	Expert	Caring	Trustworthy

Wellington (2010). PERFECT describes the basics of care. To stand out, you must also exceed expectations.

Exceeding expectations and adding value

Little and often
A series of small surprises works better than one big one now and then.

Planned spontaneity
Plan small, personal gestures that feel natural: flowers for a new baby, a card on a customer's anniversary.

Link to Kano: PERFECT behaviour is mostly **basic**: customers expect it and are angry without it. Small surprises are **delighters**. Remember the Chapter 2 rule: **basics first, then delighters.**

The opposite: small negative details

A car comes back from a service with the plastic cover still on the seat and the seat moved. The repair was fine, but the customer remembers the details. **Small details work in both directions.**

APPLY IT · LEVEL 5

Audit your capstone organisation

Rate your capstone organisation on each element, from 1 (poor) to 5 (excellent). Then write the evidence for your lowest score.

Element	1	2	3	4	5
1 · Product or service					
2 · Sales					
3 · After-sales					
4 · Location					
5 · Time					
6 · Culture					

My lowest element is ___ because the evidence shows ___.

PERFECT self-check for the frontline team

Which letter of PERFECT is weakest in your organisation's first contact? Give one example and one fix.

"The weakest is ___. For example, ___. I would fix it by ___."

Link it to Kano

Choose one feature from your lowest element. Is it a basic, a performance feature or a delighter? What should the manager do first?

For your capstone: use this audit as evidence in Capstone Step 2, when you rank the weakest moments of truth.